LAYLA SHALASH

UNDERGRADUATE STUDENT AT UNIVERSITY OF CINCINNATI

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Curious and reliable cybersecurity student with rigorous coursework in operating systems, network security, and ethical hacking. Known for clear communication, and problem-solving in academic projects and Capture the Flag challenges like PicoCTF and National Cyber League. Currently preparing for the CompTIA A+ certification (expected December 2025) to strengthen technical fundamentals and build hands-on IT skills.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's of Science in Cybersecurity **Aug 2025 - May 2030**
University of Cincinnati

EXPERIENCE

Tech Consultant / Guest Service Advocate **Nov 2024 - present**
Target | West Chester, OH

- Assisted guests in a fast-paced environment, resolved concerns, and promoted digital & in-store services
- Evaluated and recommended technology solutions, ensuring guest security and performance needs
- Guided customers on product features and usage

Workspace Engineer Intern **June 2025 - Aug 2025**
Encore Technologies | Norwood, Ohio

- Documented troubleshooting steps and resolutions during live bridge calls with technicians
- Gained exposure with 4G-to-5G Wi-Fi upgrade processes
- Monitored network performance and flagged connectivity issues during upgrade testing phases

Girl Security National Fellows Cohort **Oct 2024 - Mar 2025**
Girl Security | Remote

- Completed cybersecurity simulations addressing real-world national security challenges
- Collaborated with fellows and mentors to analyze threats and propose strategic solutions
- Strengthened public speaking and research skills through presentations and policy briefings

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Password cracking with Kali Linux
- Used Nmap for port scanning and OS detection
- Captured and analyzed packets using wireshark
- Comfortable navigating iOS, Windows, and Chrome OS
- Experienced in managing budgets and handling financial documents
- Skilled in using Microsoft Office Suite and Google Workspace
- Python
- Java

ACHIEVEMENTS

AP Scholar Award **July 2025**
AP College Board

- Outstanding college-level achievement by receiving scores of 3 or higher on three or more AP exams

Persistence and Grit Award **May 2025**
Lakota Cyber Academy

- Bestowed upon students who successfully work through their frustrations to accomplish a goal

Emerging Cyber Leader Award **May 2024**
Lakota Cyber Academy

- Takes advantage of opportunities to increase participation and success in the Cyber program